



Dries De Ridder

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

✉ dries.deridder@hotmail.com

☎ +32 473 40 87 57

✦ Antwerpen, Belgium

🌐 driesderidder.com

➦ github.com/DriesDeRidder · linkedin.com/in/dries-de-ridder

Senior software engineer with 7 years in VR. Co-creator of Spectr, the in-house framework powering most of VR Base's work, and lead developer on Blackwood and Cargo. I gravitate toward work that makes the team faster — editor tools, build automation, and performance.

Experience

Software Engineer · VRBase

Sep 2019 — Present

Mechelen, Belgium · Location-based VR entertainment

Spectr — Co-creator & Lead Developer

In-house modular VR framework powering most of VR Base's work — industrial simulations for Kellanova, Mars, DEME, Lantis, and SPIE, plus our in-house games. Own the architecture and multiplayer layer. Built an automated build pipeline that turns client models into ready-to-ship .exe files — cut turnaround from 5–8 hours to under 2. Travelled to Kellanova's plant in São Lourenço, Brazil to interview operators and map their production workflow into our model.

Blackwood — Lead Developer & Project Lead

Free-roam co-op VR medieval shooter for 1–12 players in location-based arenas. Ran the timeline in Jira and built the enemy AI, leaderboards, and core narrative. Currently our 2nd most-played game out of 10.

Cargo — Lead Developer

VR Base's first free-roam team deathmatch — two arenas stitched into one 27×13m space. Led level design, gameplay loop, and multiplayer networking. My first project lead at the studio.

Performance & Optimization

Go-to engineer for profiling across our titles. Track down CPU/GPU bottlenecks and keep frame times within VR's tight headroom on Quest and PC-VR. Built reusable runtime systems — realtime occlusion culling, BIM scene streaming, async light baking.

Internal Tooling

Editor tools that make the team faster — including a bulk material-assignment tool for our CAD-to-PBR workflow. Several open-sourced on my GitHub.

Software Developer · Damen Naval

Feb — Jun 2019

Vlissingen, Netherlands · Internship

VR simulation for operating heavy machinery aboard naval vessels.

Education

Digital Arts & Entertainment

2016 — 2019

Howest University of Applied Sciences, Kortrijk

Major in Independent Game Production

Ranked #1 Game Design & Development school worldwide — 2017, 2018, 2021

Highlights

7 years shipping commercial VR

4 VR titles led at VR Base

260K+ players across titles I've worked on

3× faster client build pipeline (8h → 2h)

Skills

EXPERT

Unity

C#

Editor Scripting

Profiling & Optimization

PROFICIENT

FishNet

Mirror

HLSL / Shaders

Build Automation

Git

SQL Server

Design Patterns

Project Management

FAMILIAR

OpenXR

SteamVR

Meta SDK

JavaScript

Photoshop

Languages

Dutch

● ● ● ● ●

English

● ● ● ● ●

French

● ● ● ● ●

Outside Work

→ Hiking, backpacking, trail running

→ Former youth leader (Chiro)

→ Reading